

CHRISTINA BOWEN

knowledge ecologist · christina@knowledgeecologist.me

QUALIFICATIONS

- Transdisciplinary systems thinker with a science background spanning wetland ecology, environmental science, and complex living systems
- Representational architecture and adaptive strategy mapping — making the state of complex systems legible to the humans navigating them
- Product strategy, UX design, and information architecture for knowledge-systems software
- Network and systems visualization; ecosystem mapping using tools such as Kumu
- Multi-stakeholder facilitation and inquiry-centered process design for organizations, networks, and civic institutions
- Cooperative co-founder and organizational coherence practice across distributed, self-organizing teams

Traces information flows in human organizations as an ecologist sensing a watershed — surfacing what is missing, where to focus, and which paths lead somewhere worth going. Two decades of practice spanning wetland ecology, systems mapping, multi-stakeholder facilitation, and software product design, unified by a single question: how do we make the state of complex systems legible to the humans navigating them.

EXPERIENCE

Atlas Research Group · co-founder

Jan 2026 – present

Core team operations, product design, business strategy, partnerships, and fundraising for a public good research lab and consultancy building sovereign wayfinding infrastructure. Supports organizational coherence and network cultivation across a distributed group of researchers, mappers, and sociotechnologists — designing intervention surfaces at the edges of complexity, science, and civic life.

Wicked Co-op, LCA · co-founder

2019 – 2025 (remains volunteer maintainer)

Product research and partnership strategy for first co-op awarded a Phase 2 NSF SBIR Grant. Representational architecture and SME in human network dynamics and design for Socialroots cross-group coordination software.

Digital Life Collective · co-founder

2016 – present

Co-founded cooperative exploring overlaps between software, hardware, and human interpersonal data. See diglife.com

Sageland Consulting · principal

2012 – 2020

Strategic consultation, multi-stakeholder facilitation, and adaptive strategy mapping for organizations and networks navigating complex change. Built ecosystem maps — intertwined network and systems visualizations — that made the state of complex systems legible to the humans navigating them. Clients included private organizations, NGOs, and civic government.

Full-time mom

2009 – 2012

Self explanatory!

DeVaney Consulting, Inc. · Land Use Planning Associate

Apr 2007 – Apr 2009, June 2010-2012

Reviewed land use applications for municipalities and assisted private clients in application submission. Coordinated with local agencies for site visits including WDFW and ODFW. Wrote ordinance updates for local communities.

Edd Clark and Assoc. · Environmental Scientist & Technician

Sept 2006 – March 2007

Groundwater monitoring at 50+ leaking fuel storage tank sites. Wrote quarterly monitoring reports and sensitive receptor surveys. Assisted on excavation and drilling projects.

U.S. Geological Survey · Biological Science Technician

Aug 2004 – Dec 2005

Field, lab and report work on a study of the biological parameters of the SF Bay salt ponds.

WA Dept. of Fish and Wildlife · At-sea observer

Jul – Oct 2001

Identified by-catch species on a working flounder fishing vessel.

Self-employed · Shiatsu practitioner

Oct 1999 – Jun 2001

Bodyworker. Primary client was Headwaters Capital, LLC

Suginami Aikikai, SF · Live-in Apprentice

Mar 1997 – Aug 1998

Work/study intensive towards black-belt (10+ classes a week). Taught children's classes at international schools in Japan and a cooperative elementary school in Deming, WA.

Clean Water Action, SF · Canvasser & trainer

Nov 1995 – Mar 1997

Door-to-door activism and fundraising.

EDUCATION

Western Washington University, Huxley College · Env Science

2001 – 2004

Aikido Black Belt · Uchideshi · Suginami Aikikai, SF

1997 – 1999

Live-in apprenticeship training intensively towards black belt. Co-founded college club. Two months at world headquarters (Japan).

Reed College · Portland, OR — early admission, biochemistry

1992 – 1994